GGG-C-00835B(GSA-FSS)
October 27, 1970
INTERIM REVISION OF
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September 4, 1963

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CUTTER, STEEL STRAPPING

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standardization Division, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers hand-operated cutters used for cutting steel strapping when tightly drawn around boxes, bales, bundles, cases, and other similar packing and shipping containers.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. Steel strapping cutters shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I Light duty.
Type II Heavy duty.
Type III Strap retaining.

Class 1 Single side retaining.
Class 2 Double side retaining.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specification:

QQ-S-698 - Steel, Sheet and Strip, Low Carbon.
PPP-P-40 - Packaging and Packing of Hand Tools.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Test Method Std No. 151 - Metals; Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 5110

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Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Bureau of Standards (NBS) Handbook:
H28 - Screw-Thread Standards for Federal Services.

(Application for copies of National Bureau of Standards Handbook should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402. Price may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Illustrations. For identification purposes only.

3.2 Material. Of steel, unless otherwise specified, and free from defects which may adversely affect the finished product.

3.3 Finish. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), one of the following finishes:

(a) Lacquered or painted.
(b) Chemically produced oxide coating, oil treated.
(c) Chemically produced phosphate coating, oil treated.
(d) Zinc or other equally suitable plating.

3.4 Interchangeability of parts. Construct all parts having the same manufacturer's part number to definite standards, tolerances, and clearances that such parts are completely interchangeable.

3.5 Identification marking. Mark each cutter in a permanent and legible manner with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

3.6 Threads. When used, all threads to conform with National Bureau of Standards Handbook H28 and latest supplement thereto.

3.7 Design and Construction. Furnish cutters well designed and constructed to facilitate steel strap cutting by manual operation. Join the cutter components using a bolt and nut, pin or other similar means, so that the jaws will have no evidence of side motion, but will cut smoothly and easily.

3.7.1 Handles. Design handles for comfortable handgrip, and produce from any material having adequate strength to pass the applicable tests herein. Design angled handles to prevent the operator's hand from being pinched or scraped when the cutter is pushed under the strapping to be cut.

3.7.1.1 Handle stops. Provide stops to prevent handles from pinching operator's hand when fully closed.

3.7.2 Jaws. Harden to Rockwell C 55-62 (see 4.4.2). Taper end of jaw to be inserted under strapping, so that tip thickness is 1/16 inch (max.), and bottom jaw surface is flat.

3.7.3 Harden all bolts, screws, rivets and pins that act as pivots for the cutter halves (and links, if any) to Rockwell C 43 (min.) (see 4.4.2), or case-harden equivalently (see 4.4.2.1).

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3.8 Type I, light duty cutter. Similar to figure 1 with two cutting jaws, two handles and a return spring. Design for cutting steel strapping up to 0.035 inch thick by 3/4 inch wide.

3.8.1 Jaws and Handles. Adequate to pass test in 4.4.3.

3.8.2 Spring. Provide a spring to return handles to the open position when handles are released.

3.8.3 Weight. Not to exceed 4 pounds.

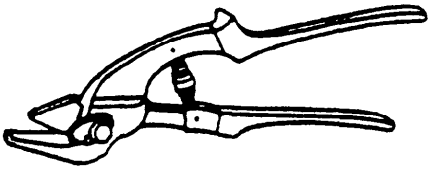


FIGURE 1. Type 1, light duty, fixed cutting blade.

3.9 Type II, heavy duty cutter. Similar to figure 2 with two cutting jaws and two handles. Design to cut steel strapping up to and including 0.050 inch thick by 2 inches wide.

3.9.1 Jaws and Handles. Adequate to pass test in 4.4.3.

3.9.2 Weight. Not to exceed 8 pounds.

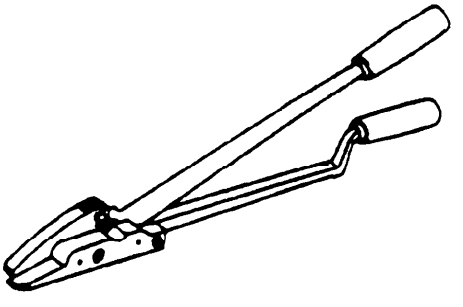


FIGURE 2. Type II, heavy duty, forward cutting action.

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3.10 Type III, strap retaining cutters. Designed to retain the cut ends of the steel strapping until jaws are opened by the operator.

3.10.1 Class 1, single side retaining. Similar to figure 3 and providing at least one steel adjustable strap retaining device so that after the steel strapping is cut, at least one end of the strapping is retained until the handles are released by the operator.

3.10.1.1 When specified (see 6.1), permanently mark body or handles with additional marking.

3.10.1.2 Produce the remaining cutter components as specified in 3.8, 3.8.1, 3.8.2 and 3.8.3.

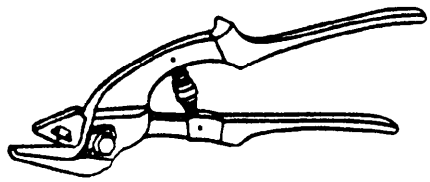
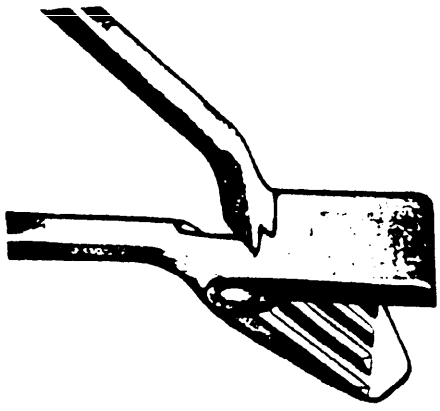


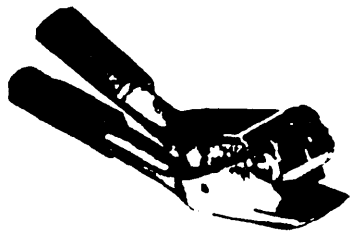
FIGURE 3. Type III, class 1, single side retaining.

3.10.2 Class 2, double side retaining. Similar to either option "A" or "B" of figure 4 and providing two steel strap retaining devices so that after the steel strapping is cut, both ends are retained until the handles are released by the operator.

3.10.2.1 Except for the handle return spring which is not required, produce the remaining cutter components as specified in 3.8, 3.8.1, and 3.8.3.



Option "A"



Option "B"

FIGURE 4. Type III, class 2, double side retaining.

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3.11 Workmanship. First class in every respect, having no defects that could adversely affect the serviceability or durability of the cutter.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified herein, or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling procedures. Sampling procedures shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Data for sampling shall be as stated in table I.

TABLE I. Sampling data

Category	Sample unit	Inspection level	Acceptable quality level	AQL expressed in terms of	Reference
Visual examination	1 each	II	1.5	Defects per hundred units	4.3.1
Dimensional and weight examination	1 each	S-4	1.5	do.	4.3.2
Testing	1 each	S-3	2.5	do.	4.4
Preparation for delivery	one container	S-2	4.0	do.	4.5

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination. Each sample unit shall be examined for any nonconformance in design, material, finish, coating, construction, workmanship, and marking. Defects are listed in table II.

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TABLE II. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Finish	Missing where required ...	X	
	Area of no film		X
	Blistered, peeled, chipped, scratched, or foreign matter imbedded		X
	Indication of rust.....		X
Design	Any characteristic not in accordance with the specified requirements.....	X	
Construction and workmanship, general	Part missing	X	
	Sharp burr or edges that may be injurious to personnel	X	
	Fractured, split, sprung, cracked, malformed, dented, bowed, broken, or otherwise impaired	X	
	Handles require abnormal force to operate	X	
	Loose or not in proper alignment.....	X	
	Not connected or joined as specified.....	X	
	Forgings not free from scale, inclosures, cold shuts or seams.....		X
	Castings badly miscast, or incomplete.....	X	
	Castings contain blowholes, porosity, hard spots, shrinkage defects, or cracks.....		
Welding and brazing (where applicable)	Missing.....	X	
	Completely broken or not fused.....	X	
	Burnt holes, slag inclusion, noncontinuous where required, undercut, cracked, or partially broken.....	X	
	Excess weld or braze.....		X
Riveting (where applicable)	Missing.....	X	
	Loose, cracked, broken, or otherwise damaged.....	X	
Bolts, nuts, screws, studs, and other types of threaded fasteners	Missing.....	X	
	Broken, stripped, or fractured.....	X	

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TABLE II. Classification of defects (Cont'd.)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Assembly	Unit not properly assembled or secured or does not function as required.....	X	
	Unit perceptibly out of alignment.....	X	
Marking identification	Missing, incomplete, not legible, not permanent, or not as specified.....		X

4.3.2 Dimensional and weight examination. Examine each sample unit for any nonconformance with dimensional and weight requirements.

4.4 Test methods.

4.4.1 Test procedures. Test each sample unit in accordance with 4.4.2 thru 4.4.2.1.

4.4.2 Hardness test. In accordance with Method 2A3.1 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151.

4.4.2.1 When case hardening is used, test on the Rockwell 15N scale (superficial). The item is acceptable if the Rockwell 15N is not less than 82.

4.4.3 Steel strap cutting test. Make twelve cuts in steel strapping 0.035 inch thick by 3/4 inch wide for types I and III cutters, and 12 cuts in 0.050 inch thick by 2 inches wide strapping for type II cutters. The steel strapping utilized for testing is to be not more than 75 nor less than 65 on the Rockwell "B" scale (#3, quarter-hard temper) as specified in Federal Specification QQ-S-698. Steel strapping is to be cut without any assistance from the operator such as bending, twisting, or pulling the steel strapping.

4.4.4 Handle over-load test. After the test described in 4.4.3 has been conducted, make one cut using 0.050 inch thick by 3/4 inch wide steel strapping for types I and III cutters, and one cut in 0.075 inch by 2 inches wide steel strapping for type II cutters. The same steel strapping required in 4.4.3 is to be used for this test. Next measure the distance between the ends of the handles (in closed position). Repeat the above applicable cutting process and re-measure the distance between the ends of the handles (in closed position). Permanent set not to exceed 1/32 inch Any visible evidence of chipped, cracked, bent or broken parts shall be cause for rejection.

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that preservation, packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Contents	Quantities not as specified.
Containers	Not the kind specified.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate strapping; distortion of container.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with PPP-P-[illegible]. The level of preservation, packaging, and packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, or type and class required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Level of preservation, packaging, and packing required (see 5.1).
(d) When additional marking is required (see 3.10.1.1).

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GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION - FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: General Services Administration, FSS (FMSK), Wash., D.C. 20406.

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

GGG-C-00835B(GSA-FSS) Cutter, Steel Strapping

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA FEB 69 2200

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